

Joe Karlsson

Developer Advocate & Engineering Lead

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Developer advocate and engineering lead with 15 years building developer communities, owning web presence end-to-end, and making complex products click for the developers who use them. I've run full DevRel functions — content strategy, community, events, docs, video, and the web properties themselves — at data and infrastructure companies. I know what it takes to grow a developer audience from scratch and keep them engaged.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Developer Advocate

2024 - Present

CloudQuery · Remote

Astro · TypeScript · React · Tailwind CSS · SEO · Analytics

- Sole owner of all CloudQuery web properties — marketing site, docs, and developer hub — responsible for the full developer experience from first impression to product activation
- Defined and execute end-to-end DevRel strategy: content roadmap, community growth, developer onboarding, event presence, webinar series, and video production
- Built organic developer acquisition channel from scratch — 4.9x impression growth, average search position improved from 21.0 to 10.3 in the first month
- Grew docs engagement 302% and drove Quickstart completions from 0 to 23/week through a full developer experience overhaul
- Organic MQLs +216% MoM; demo submissions 7x MoM — content strategy with a direct line to revenue

Senior Developer Advocate

2023 - 2024

Tinybird · Remote

Python · SQL · GCP · AWS · Kafka · Technical Writing

- Developed developer education content and onboarding material for a real-time data platform targeting data engineers and full-stack developers
- Built and engaged community through workshops, webinars, and online forums; represented Tinybird at industry conferences
- Produced technical demos and sample applications that reduced time-to-first-value for new developers

Senior Developer Advocate

2021 - 2023

SingleStore · Remote

JavaScript · Node.js · SQL · Video Production · Developer Relations

- Created technical content, conference talks, and documentation for developers migrating from traditional SQL databases
- Collaborated with the partnerships team on co-marketed demos, workshops, and developer events
- Represented SingleStore at developer conferences and produced video content covering real-time analytics use cases

Developer Advocate

2019 - 2021

MongoDB · Remote

JavaScript · Node.js · React · Video · Community · Live Streaming

- Keynoted at MongoDB World and spoke at hundreds of developer conferences globally — driving community growth and product adoption at scale
- Owned MongoDB's live stream and video production; built a 25K+ TikTok following and was ranked #1 on "Must-Follow Developers on TikTok"
- Developed best practices content — schema design, Atlas, and NoSQL architecture — that became some of the most referenced tutorials in the ecosystem
- TEDx Speaker — "The Art of Computer Science" — delivered as both a TEDx talk and keynote at multiple conferences

Front End Technical Lead

2017 - 2019

Best Buy · Minneapolis, MN

JavaScript · React · Redux · Node.js · CSS · AWS

- Led front end engineering on one of the top 3 largest eCommerce sites in North America — millions of users, thousands of requests per second
- Owned Account Home for bestbuy.com end-to-end: architecture, implementation, and a team of engineers through a full redesign
- Helped architect and scale one of the most performant retail front ends on the web, with a focus on reliability and user experience at scale
- Engineered AI-driven chatbot that reduced customer support call volume by 25%

Full-Stack JavaScript Instructor

2015 - 2017

DevLeague · Honolulu, HI

JavaScript · React · Node.js · CSS · PostgreSQL

- Taught full-stack JavaScript at one of the top 10 coding bootcamps worldwide
- Developed curriculum and mentored students into engineering roles — built teaching instincts that underpin everything I do in DevRel

SKILLS

FRONTEND

JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Astro, CSS, Tailwind CSS, D3.js

DEVREL & CONTENT

Content Strategy, Developer Experience, Community, Conference Speaking, Video Production, Webinars, SEO

WEB & INFRASTRUCTURE

Node.js, AWS, GCP, Docker, GitHub Actions, Analytics, A/B Testing

HIGHLIGHTS

- TEDx Speaker — "The Art of Computer Science" (also delivered as a conference keynote)
- Ranked #1 on "10 Must-Follow Developers on TikTok" — 25K+ followers, 844K+ likes
- Hackathon organizer — "Stupid Shit No One In Hawaii Needs" (2016), sponsored by GitHub & Frontend Masters
- Published in The New Stack, MongoDB Developer Hub, Medium, and DEV Community
- Arctic Code Vault Contributor

SELECTED PROJECTS

BECHDEL.IO

Bechdel Test script analyzer — parses film scripts to test for gender representation. A digital humanities project I built with my sister.

REAL-TIME GRAFFITI WALL

Collaborative canvas app where anyone on the internet can draw in real time. Built with WebSockets and the Canvas API.

SPOTIFY REACT PLAYER

Full Spotify player built in React using the Spotify Web API — playback controls, search, and queue management.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

2008 - 2012

Gustavus Adolphus College

GPA: 3.5 · Minors: Art History, Math